

SIMATS ENGINEERING
ASSESSMENT TOOL 1
ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (CSA1708)

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1. Water Jug Problem

Problem Understanding

Two unmarked jugs have capacities 4 gallons and 3 gallons. Allowed operations are: fill a jug completely from the pump, empty a jug onto the ground, and pour water from one jug to the other until either the source is empty or the destination is full. The objective is to obtain exactly 2 gallons in the 4-gallon jug.

State-Space Formulation

Element	Definition
State	(x,y), where x = water in 4-gallon jug ($0 \leq x \leq 4$) and y = water in 3-gallon jug ($0 \leq y \leq 3$).
Initial state	(0,0)
Goal test	x = 2; a convenient goal state is (2,0).
Operators	Fill 4J, Fill 3J, Empty 4J, Empty 3J, Pour 4J→3J, Pour 3J→4J.
Path cost	Each operation may be treated as one step.

Solution Process

Step	Operation	State (4J,3J)
0	Start	(0,0)
1	Fill 3-gallon jug	(0,3)
2	Pour 3J → 4J	(3,0)
3	Fill 3-gallon jug again	(3,3)
4	Pour 3J → 4J until 4J is full	(4,2)
5	Empty 4-gallon jug	(0,2)
6	Pour 3J → 4J	(2,0)

State sequence: (0,0) → (0,3) → (3,0) → (3,3) → (4,2) → (0,2) → (2,0).

Interpretation of Result

The final state is (2,0), so the 4-gallon jug contains exactly 2 gallons. The goal is achieved in 6 valid operations without using any measuring device.

2. Mars Rover – Intelligent Agent Analysis

Problem Understanding

A Mars Rover must autonomously perceive an unknown environment, navigate safely, select scientific targets, collect/analyse samples, manage limited resources and communicate results to Earth. A PEAS-style analysis and task-environment characterization are appropriate.

i. Percepts

- Camera images of terrain, rocks and navigation hazards.
- Range/proximity and terrain information used for obstacle detection and localization.
- Temperature, atmospheric pressure, radiation, dust/weather and other environmental measurements.
- Rock/soil mineralogical and chemical-composition measurements from scientific instruments.
- Position, orientation, wheel odometry/slip, arm/tool status, battery level, power generation, communication and overall system-health data.

ii. Operating Environment

Dimension	Characterization	Reason
Observability	Partially observable	Sensors provide only limited/local and sometimes noisy information; the complete Martian state is not directly known.
Determinism	Stochastic / uncertain	Wheel slip, terrain interaction, dust and sensor uncertainty can make action outcomes unpredictable.
Episodic vs sequential	Sequential	Each navigation or sampling decision affects later states, energy and future choices.
Static vs dynamic	Dynamic / semi-dynamic	Environmental conditions and resource levels can change while the rover plans and acts.
Discrete vs continuous	Mostly continuous	Position, time, energy, temperature and motion vary continuously, although commands may be discrete.
Agents	Primarily single-agent	The rover acts autonomously in its local environment, coordinated with mission control.
Known vs unknown	Partially unknown	Some terrain properties and scientific characteristics must be discovered during exploration.

iii. Actions

- Drive forward/backward, turn, stop and navigate to waypoints.
- Avoid hazards, re-plan paths and select safe terrain.
- Move robotic arm/mast and position scientific instruments.
- Drill, abrade, scoop or collect rock/soil samples where supported by the rover's tools.
- Capture images, perform scientific measurements and analyse samples.
- Store/compress/transmit data and receive high-level commands from Earth.
- Manage battery/power, thermal state, communication and safe-mode operations.

iv. Performance Evaluation

A suitable performance measure includes: scientific value and quality of data collected; number of mission objectives completed; navigation safety and hazard avoidance; accuracy/success of sample analysis; energy and time efficiency; rover health and reliability; communication success; useful distance/area explored; and survival within operational constraints.

v. Suitable Agent Architecture

A hybrid model-based, goal/utility-based learning architecture is most suitable. A model-based component maintains an internal estimate of the partially observable world; goal-based planning chooses actions that accomplish mission objectives; utility-based reasoning balances scientific value, risk, time and energy; learning/adaptation improves decisions from experience. A reactive layer is also valuable for immediate safety responses such as stopping before a hazard.

Conclusion

The rover is best treated as an autonomous rational agent that combines sensing, internal state estimation, planning, utility/risk evaluation, learning and reactive safety control.

3. 8-Queens Problem – Search Space and Search Strategy

Problem Understanding

The task is to place eight queens on an 8×8 chessboard so that no two queens attack each other. Therefore, no two queens may share a row, column or diagonal.

Problem Formulation

Component	Formulation
State representation	A partial placement $[r_1, r_2, \dots, r_k]$, where r_i is the row of the queen in column i and $k \leq 8$.
Initial state	Empty board: $[]$ ($k=0$).
Actions / successor	Place one queen in the next column in any row not attacked by already placed queens.
Transition model	Append the selected safe row to the partial placement.
Goal test	$k=8$ and all queens are pairwise non-attacking.
Path cost	One unit per queen placement; a complete placement has depth 8.

Search Space

If each column could independently choose any of 8 rows, there are 8^8 possible column-wise assignments before constraints are applied. By placing one queen per column and rejecting row/diagonal conflicts immediately, the search space is greatly reduced.

Method Selection: DFS with Backtracking

Depth-First Search with backtracking is appropriate because it explores one placement sequence deeply, detects constraint violations early, and returns to the previous decision when a dead end is reached. This avoids storing a very large frontier.

Safety Test

For a new queen at (r,c) and an existing queen at (ri,i), it is safe only if $r \neq ri$ and $|r-ri| \neq |c-i|$ for every existing queen. One queen per column automatically eliminates column conflicts.

Pseudocode

```
SOLVE_QUEENS(column):
  if column > 8:
    return SUCCESS
  for row = 1 to 8:
    if SAFE(row, column):
      PLACE queen at (row, column)
      if SOLVE_QUEENS(column + 1) = SUCCESS:
        return SUCCESS
      REMOVE queen from (row, column) // backtrack
  return FAILURE
```

Example Valid Goal State

One valid arrangement, listing the row selected for columns 1 to 8, is [1,5,8,6,3,7,2,4]. Hence the queens are at (1,1), (5,2), (8,3), (6,4), (3,5), (7,6), (2,7), (4,8). Every row and column is unique, and no pair satisfies the diagonal-conflict condition.

Interpretation

The formulation converts the puzzle into a state-space search problem. DFS with backtracking systematically explores legal partial states and terminates when all 8 queens are placed without conflicts.

4. OLA Cab Booking – Problem-Solving Agent

Problem Understanding

The customer provides a pickup location, destination and preferences, and the application must choose among available cab categories/routes to achieve the travel goal. This is naturally modeled as a goal-based problem-solving task; utility criteria can refine the choice among alternatives.

Type of Agent and Justification

A goal-based problem-solving agent is the primary answer because it identifies a goal state (reach the destination), formulates the problem, searches/evaluates possible actions and executes a solution. When

several alternatives all reach the goal, a utility-based selection can rank them using fare, ETA, travel time, comfort and user preference.

Problem Formulation

Component	OLA Interpretation
Initial state	Customer at pickup/source location S.
Goal state	Customer reaches destination G.
State space	Road locations/intersections together with relevant cab availability/status.
Actions	Choose cab category, book/assign cab, move along a road segment, re-route if required.
Transition model	An action changes cab/customer location or booking status.
Goal test	Current location = destination and trip is completed.
Path/utility measure	Distance, fare, ETA/travel time, comfort, availability and possibly traffic.

Pseudocode

OLA_PROBLEM_SOLVING_AGENT(source, destination, preference):

```
goal ← destination
cabs ← GET_AVAILABLE_CABS(source)
if cabs = empty:
    return FAILURE ("No cab available")
for each cab in cabs:
    estimate pickup_ETA, fare, travel_time and comfort
    compute suitability according to preference
selected_cab ← BEST_SUITABLE_CAB(cabs)
route ← SEARCH_BEST_ROUTE(source, destination)
if selected_cab = NONE or route = NONE:
    return FAILURE
BOOK(selected_cab)
ASSIGN_DRIVER(selected_cab)
EXECUTE(route)
if current_location = destination:
    return SUCCESS
else:
    REPLAN and continue
```

Interpretation

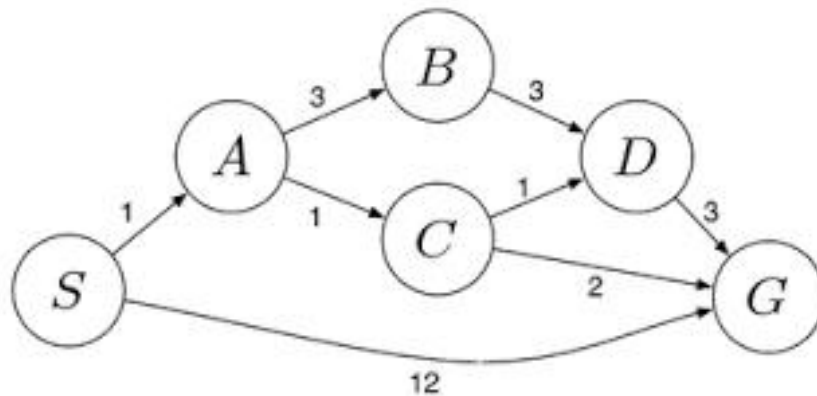
The goal-based agent ensures that actions lead from source to destination, while utility-based ranking helps select the most suitable cab/route when multiple valid choices exist.

5. Uniform Cost Search (UCS) – Least-Cost Warehouse Route

Problem Understanding

The weighted directed graph represents travel costs between warehouses. The task is to find the path from S to G with minimum cumulative cost. Uniform Cost Search is appropriate because it always expands the frontier node with the smallest path cost $g(n)$ and, with non-negative edge costs, returns an optimal solution.

Graph / Edge Costs



Directed Edge	Cost
S → A	1
S → G	12
A → B	3
A → C	1
B → D	3
C → D	1
C → G	2
D → G	3

UCS Algorithm

UCS(start, goal):

frontier $\leftarrow$ priority queue containing (start, cost 0)

best_cost[start] $\leftarrow$ 0

while frontier is not empty:

node $\leftarrow$ remove entry with minimum cumulative cost

if node = goal:

return path and cumulative cost

for each successor of node:

new_cost $\leftarrow$ cost(node) + edge_cost(node, successor)

if successor is new OR new_cost < best_cost[successor]:

update best_cost and parent

insert/update successor in frontier
 return FAILURE

Step-by-Step Frontier Expansion

Step	Node Expanded	$g(n)$	Frontier after expansion (lowest first)
0	S	0	A:1, G:12
1	A	1	C:2, B:4, G:12
2	C	2	D:3, G:4, B:4 (G updated from 12 to 4)
3	D	3	G:4, B:4 (path to G via D costs 6, so keep G:4)
4	B or G (tie at 4)	4	If B is expanded first, D via B costs 7 and gives no improvement. Then G:4 is selected.
5	G	4	Goal removed from priority queue; terminate.

Cost Calculation

Optimal path: $S \rightarrow A \rightarrow C \rightarrow G$

Cost = $c(S,A) + c(A,C) + c(C,G) = 1 + 1 + 2 = 4$ units.

Verification with Other Complete Routes

Path	Total Cost
$S \rightarrow G$	12
$S \rightarrow A \rightarrow C \rightarrow G$	$1+1+2 = 4$
$S \rightarrow A \rightarrow C \rightarrow D \rightarrow G$	$1+1+1+3 = 6$
$S \rightarrow A \rightarrow B \rightarrow D \rightarrow G$	$1+3+3+3 = 10$

Final Result and Engineering Interpretation

The least-cost route is $S \rightarrow A \rightarrow C \rightarrow G$ with total cost 4 units. For the logistics company, selecting this route minimizes the modeled combined fuel/time cost among the available routes. UCS is complete and optimal here because all route costs are non-negative.